

Unified Sales Intelligence Platform

Full question set & rationale for connecting Business Central, LS Retail, Squirrel, Bayan and adjacent systems into a single AI-powered executive dashboard.

Prepared for: [Client] | Prepared by: [Your Company] | Date: [Date]

Our objective is a single, trusted view of sales and revenue across every channel — retail, hospitality and finance — feeding an AI layer that gives leadership answers, not just charts. We treat your existing systems as the source of truth and build a clean, governed, scalable pipeline on top of them. The questions below are how we de-risk the build before any integration is written. You don't need polished answers to all of them today — rough notes, or simply naming the right person per system, lets us move quickly. Items flagged **PRIORITY** are the high-leverage questions summarised in the accompanying email; the rest complete the picture.

1. Foundations — access, environments & ownership

Integration timelines are decided here, not in the code. How each system is hosted and who owns it tells us whether we connect via clean cloud APIs or need network/VPN work — and who we'll partner with on each side.

- 1. For each system (Business Central, LS Retail, Squirrel, Bayan), is it cloud-hosted (SaaS), vendor-hosted, or on-premise — and which version/edition are you on?** **PRIORITY**
Why: Cloud editions usually expose modern APIs we can consume securely over the internet; on-prem deployments need a connectivity layer. This single answer shapes the architecture and the timeline.
- 2. Who is the implementation partner or internal owner/administrator for each system?**
Why: We'll want a named technical counterpart per system. Naming them now prevents the most common cause of delay — waiting on access nobody is empowered to grant.
- 3. Do you have non-production environments (sandbox/test) for each system that we can integrate against first?** **PRIORITY**
Why: We never develop against live financial or POS systems. A sandbox lets us validate data and build safely with zero risk to your operations.
- 4. Are there existing integrations or a current BI/reporting setup (Power BI, Excel exports, a data warehouse) we should be aware of?**
Why: Understanding what's already in place lets us reuse your investments, avoid duplicating pipelines, and see exactly where today's reporting falls short.

2. Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central — the finance backbone

Business Central is almost certainly your system of record for revenue — where channel sales reconcile to the general ledger. It anchors the truth in the dashboard.

- 5. Is this Business Central SaaS (online) or on-prem/hosted, and which API surface is available — standard REST/OData v4 APIs, custom AL extensions, or the Microsoft Fabric / Dataverse link?** **PRIORITY**
Why: Modern BC online offers first-class APIs and a native Fabric data link — the most scalable path. This lets us choose the right, supported integration method rather than a brittle one.
- 6. Which entities are in scope — posted sales invoices, sales orders, GL entries, items, customers — and how frequently is sales data posted (real-time, hourly, end-of-day)?**
Why: This defines what we pull and how live the finance view can realistically be, so we set the right expectation for leadership up front.

7. How is your Chart of Accounts and, critically, your Dimension structure set up (Department, Cost Center, Brand, Region, Outlet)?

PRIORITY

Why: Dimensions are how we classify revenue by source and business unit without guesswork. A clean dimension strategy is the difference between a dashboard that slices cleanly and one needing constant manual mapping.

8. Are you running multiple companies/legal entities, and what reporting and transactional currencies are in play?

PRIORITY

Why: Multi-entity and multi-currency (common in the UAE) must be designed for from day one — consolidating after the fact is painful. Asking now means we model it correctly.

3. LS Retail — the retail point of sale

LS is where retail transactions are born. How and when they flow to finance determines the granularity and freshness of retail revenue in the dashboard.

9. Are you on LS Central (embedded in Business Central) or an older LS Nav/LS Retail deployment, and does transaction data reside inside BC or in a separate store/head-office database?

PRIORITY

Why: If it's LS Central, retail sales may already live inside BC — which simplifies everything. If separate, we plan for store-to-HO replication. This stops us assuming one architecture and finding another.

10. At what grain and cadence are retail sales available — line-item per transaction in real time, or aggregated via statement/Z-report posting at end of day?

PRIORITY

Why: This determines whether the dashboard shows live retail sales or daily settled figures. Both are valid; leadership just needs to know which, and why.

11. How is your item/product hierarchy structured (categories, brands, variants), and do you capture loyalty or customer identifiers at the till?

Why: Product hierarchy drives category-level analytics; customer identifiers unlock basket and retention insight. We map your existing structure rather than impose a new one.

4. Squirrel — the hospitality / F&B point of sale

Squirrel runs a different channel with a different rhythm (checks, covers, voids, discounts). We understand it on its own terms, then harmonize it with retail and finance.

12. Is Squirrel cloud or on-prem, and what data access does it offer — a reporting API, scheduled data exports, or direct database access?

PRIORITY

Why: This sets the integration method for hospitality sales. A documented API is ideal; if exports are the only route, we design a reliable ingestion schedule around them.

13. What sales grain is available (check/ticket level, item level, by venue/terminal/daypart), and how are discounts, voids, comps and tips handled?

Why: Hospitality revenue is nuanced — net vs gross matters enormously. Getting these definitions right prevents the dashboard ever disagreeing with the operators on the floor.

14. How do Squirrel sales currently reconcile into Business Central — automatically, via a nightly journal, or manually?

PRIORITY

Why: POS totals must tie out to the GL. Understanding today's reconciliation lets the dashboard show numbers leadership already trusts, rather than a conflicting fourth version.

5. Bayan — HR & payroll

HR data turns raw revenue into productivity — revenue per head, labor cost as a percentage of sales. It's also the most sensitive data in the stack, so we approach it with deliberate minimalism.

15. What HR metrics do you want reflected (headcount, labor cost, productivity by outlet/department), and can Bayan expose these via API or scheduled export?

Why: We only want the aggregates that make the sales picture richer — not the full HR record. Defining this narrowly keeps the integration lean and respectful of sensitivity.

16. How are employees mapped to cost centers, outlets, or the same dimensions used in Business Central?

Why: Aligning HR to the same outlet/cost-center keys as finance and POS is what lets us compute labor-to-sales ratios automatically. Without a shared key, this becomes manual.

17. What is your policy on personally identifiable and payroll data — what may leave Bayan, and in what aggregated form?

Why: We design to data-minimization principles: pull the least sensitive data needed. Confirming your policy now keeps us compliant and builds trust with your HR stakeholders.

6. Unifying the data — master data & classification

This is the real engineering challenge. Four systems each have their own idea of an outlet, a product and a day. Stitching them into one classified, reconcilable model is where most projects quietly fail — and where we make our difference.

18. Is there a single, consistent identifier for each outlet/store/venue across Business Central, LS Retail and Squirrel — or do they use different codes?

PRIORITY

Why: A shared outlet key lets us roll every channel up to the same location cleanly. If codes differ, we build a mapping layer early rather than discovering the mismatch mid-project.

19. Likewise for products and customers — is there a common SKU/customer reference across systems, or system-specific codes?

Why: This determines whether cross-channel product and customer analytics are immediate or require an entity-resolution step. Either is fine; we just need to plan for it.

20. Which system is the authoritative source for sales when POS and finance differ — and what is your fiscal calendar (week definitions, period close)?

PRIORITY

Why: Defining the source of truth and the calendar up front means the dashboard never produces two numbers for the same thing — the fastest way to lose executive confidence.

7. "Live" data, latency & scale

Live means different things to different people, and over-engineering for real time where it isn't needed wastes money. We size the architecture to your actual rhythm and growth.

21. When you say "live sales data," what refresh truly serves the decision — near-real-time (minutes), hourly, or start-of-day?

PRIORITY

Why: Real-time streaming and daily batch are very different builds and price points. Matching freshness to the actual decision keeps this cost-effective and scalable.

22. What are the rough data volumes — transactions per day across channels, number of outlets/terminals, and peak/seasonal spikes (Ramadan, holidays)?

Why: Volume and peak shape the pipeline's sizing. Designing for your peaks now means the platform doesn't buckle during your most important trading periods.

23. How much history exists in each system, and how far back do you want to analyze and train AI on?

Why: Trends and AI forecasting are only as good as the history behind them. Knowing the depth available sets realistic expectations for predictive features.

24. What growth is on the horizon — new outlets, brands, markets or systems in the next 12–24 months?

Why: We build the architecture to absorb growth without re-platforming. Asking now is the difference between scaling smoothly and rebuilding in a year.

8. Security, identity & UAE data residency

This is a leadership-grade platform touching financial and HR data in the UAE. Security and compliance aren't a final checklist item — they're a design input.

25. Do you use Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) for identity, and should the dashboard enforce single sign-on with role-based access?

PRIORITY

Why: In a Microsoft-centric environment, SSO via Entra ID is the natural, secure path — and lets us enforce who sees what (e.g., a regional manager sees only their region) using your existing identities.

26. Are there data residency requirements — must data remain within the UAE (e.g., Azure UAE North/Central), and are any entities under DIFC/ADGM or sector-specific rules?

PRIORITY

Why: UAE PDPL and free-zone regimes can require in-country hosting. This dictates where we deploy, so we design compliant from day one rather than retrofitting.

27. Who should have access to what, and at what granularity — by brand, region, outlet or role?

Why: Defining the access model early lets us bake row-level security into the data layer itself, which is far more robust than hiding things in the UI.

9. AI scope, governance & the decisions it serves

The AI is the point of difference, and where expectations must be set with care. We want it driving real decisions, with guardrails your leadership and auditors are comfortable with.

28. What are the three or four executive questions this dashboard must answer brilliantly on day one?

Why: Anchoring the AI to real decisions — not generic insights — is how we deliver value fast and avoid building features nobody uses.

29. What is your comfort level with AI processing your data — is cloud AI acceptable (within your residency rules), and is any data off-limits for AI processing?

Why: This sets the boundary between automated analysis and sensitive data. We can architect so sensitive figures are aggregated or anonymized before any AI sees them.

30. For AI-generated recommendations and forecasts, do you want a human-in-the-loop review step before they reach leadership?

Why: Executives reject confidently-wrong AI fast. A lightweight review step protects credibility — we recommend it, and want your view on where it fits.

10. The wider ecosystem & roadmap

A complete map lets us design connectors that extend naturally to the next source, so each new system is an add-on, not a re-architecture.

31. You mentioned "many other systems" — can you share the full inventory (e-commerce, CRM, supply chain, banking) and which feed sales or revenue?

Why: A complete map lets us design connectors that extend naturally, so each new system is an add-on rather than a re-architecture.

32. Are any of these systems scheduled for upgrade, migration or replacement in the near term?

Why: We don't want to build a tight integration to something you're about to retire. Knowing your roadmap means our platform ages with your stack, not against it.